

Sudan devalues the Sudanese pound and lifts subsidies for wheat and wheat flour

Key Messages

- Ongoing harvests of the 2017/18 main agricultural season are improving household food access in most areas in Sudan, leading to Minimal (IPC Phase 1) or Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes through at least May 2018. Most IDPs in SPLM-N controlled areas of South Kordofan, and in Jebel Marra continue to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes in the harvest period.
- In parts of North Darfur and Kassala, poor seasonal performance led to substantial crop losses in agropastoral areas and very poor regeneration of pasture in pastoral areas. Households are likely to face difficulty meeting their basic food needs as livestock remain in dry season grazing areas and household milk availability is limited. Between now and May 2018, households are likely to face significant difficulty meeting their livelihoods protection needs and will begin to face food consumption gaps indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes.
- In December 2017, the Government of Sudan announced the devaluation of the Sudanese Pound from 6.7 to 18 SDG/USD, followed by the announcement in early January of the removal of subsidies for wheat and wheat flour. Together, these have contributed to significant increases in prices for staple foods, including domestically produced sorghum and millet by approximately 10-20 percent since November. Prices for wheat flour and bread more than doubled on some markets in December. These changes in the macro-economic of the country are likely to result in further increases in staple food prices and reduce poor households' ability to access food from markets.

* FEWS NET's classifications are IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. FEWS NET and the IPC use different methods to estimate the total Population in Need of humanitarian food assistance and assess the risk of Famine. Learn more at www.fews.net/about.

Key Message Update

This Key Message Update provides a high-level analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography. Learn more [here](#).